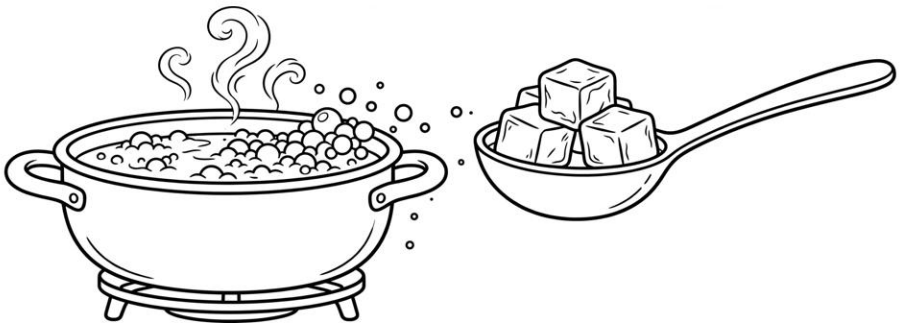
Practice: Subtracting Negative Numbers

Name: _____ Date: _____



Subtract.

1. 2 - (-1) = _____

2. 3 - (-2) = _____

3. 5 - (-4) = _____

4. 7 - (-3) = _____

5. -2 - (-5) = _____

Answer key (for the adult)

Pattern: treats subtracting a negative as subtracting a positive.
The learner subtracts the absolute value when subtracting a negative instead of adding it. This produces the wrong answers in problems 1, 2, 4, and 6. Problems 3 and 5 were correct because they only required subtracting a positive, which the learner already does well.

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1. 2 - (-1) =

Answer: 3

If you see 1, that is the habit again.

checked by an independent solve

2. 3 - (-2) =

Answer: 5

If you see 1, that is the habit again.

checked by an independent solve

3. 5 - (-4) =

Answer: 9

If you see 1, that is the habit again.

checked by an independent solve

4. 7 - (-3) =

Answer: 10

If you see 4, that is the habit again.

checked by an independent solve

5. -2 - (-5) =

Answer: 3

If you see -7, that is the habit again.

checked by an independent solve

AI can make mistakes. Every answer above was solved twice by two different models (Muse Spark and the open-weights Muse Spark Open); anything marked NOT verified needs your eye.